

History of Lit





About the Course

Using Marshall's and Long's spines along with a variety of primary sources and additional readings, the History of Literature course introduces students to literary movements and figures in the 19th century. The course prioritizes influential texts in the English-speaking world but also seeks to give students glimpses at literary developments across the globe.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12, Literature: Grade 9, Literature: Grade 10



Placement & Combining Tips

Lessons are shared across high school grades with grade-specific assignments in the lesson plans as appropriate.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	History of Lit: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	American Literature English Literature for Boys and Girls History of Literature PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 10				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	Poetry Study: Grade 10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

☐ Print off the History of Literature PDF, as students will need to annotate and mark up various sections throughout the year.

☐ Although sources were condensed into one PDF when possible, there are still quite a few outside links due to the number of primary sources referenced, so make sure your student(s) has/have access to the internet for their course.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

History of Lit: Grades 9-12



American Literature



English Literature for Boys and Girls



History of Literature PDF



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

∞ [History of Literature PDF](#)

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



History of Lit: Grades 9-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Introduction - Romanticism

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

What authors and books come to mind when you think about literature in 19th century? You may be familiar with terms such as the "Romantic period" or "Victorian period." Tell or jot down anything that comes to mind.

Over the year we'll learn about the lives and writings of people who wrote from about 1800-1900 AD. These individuals wrote in a wide array of genres: poetry, essays, short stories, plays, science fiction, mysteries, thrillers, children's stories, and more. When possible, the readings scheduled in History of Lit will align with what you are reading in your Poetry and General Literature courses.

We'll focus on authors who wrote in English but will also spend some time getting a taste for influential texts written in other languages as well. Every culture has significant texts and stories, so while we're limited in this course to English texts and texts translated into English, it's important to remember there is a world of books and literary traditions from cultures around the world which we don't have the time or often the language to read in this course!

English writings from the end of the 18th century into the first half of the 19th century are sometimes grouped together as part of the "Romantic Period." As with any generalization, this is a label scholars have put on the time frame as they look back, not something authors were so much thinking about consciously as they wrote, although as we will see, writers and poets from this period were often aware that their style of writing was something new.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: History of Lit PDF "The Romantic Period" p.#-# (7 pages)

- What are some of the themes to look out for when you read literature from the Romantic Period? How did Romantic writers break with the traditions of Classicism? Do you recognize any ideas about poets and poetry in this reading that are still current today? How would you say our time is different or similar? What "rules" define literature written in English today?

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls; History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the major themes of the Romantic Period from last week's reading?

→ INTRO

Today we will learn more about the life and work of two poets - William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge, who are most closely associated with English Romantic poetry.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Marshall, Ch.LXXIV "Wordsworth - the Poet of Nature."

- How did Wordsworth's experiences as a child seem to influence his later poetry?

2. Marshall, Ch.LXXV "Wordsworth and Coleridge - the Lake Poets."

- What are some similarities and differences between the two poets?

• IMPORTANT DATES

William Wordsworth (1770-1850)

Samuel Taylor Coleridge (1772-1834)

First publication of the Lyrical Ballads (1798)

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

Rabindranath Tagore

→ INTRO

If you are taking the Poetry Reading course this year, you will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century.

→ VIEW, NARRATE & DISCUSS

This video provides an excellent overview of Tagore's life and work. It will take nearly the entire lesson time to watch, although you can watch at 1.25x speed.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate

- What were some of Tagore's major contributions to arts and history?

→ READ

∞ Link: The Gardener 85

This short poem is a timely piece to read, since Tagore was still alive and writing a century ago.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Rabindranath Tagore (1861-1941)

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Sir Walter Scott

📄 Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ INTRO

E.M. Forster described Sir Walter Scott as a writer "over whom we shall violently divide," and certainly he has had his share of ardent readers and detractors. But one reason his works are still appreciated, as the literary critic Walter Allen said, is that "without being in the strict sense an historian, he revolutionized the writing of history." Today we will learn more about this author whom Virginia Woolf described as "perhaps the last novelist to practice the great, the Shakespearean art, of making people reveal themselves in speech," and of whom Jane Austen said, "Walter Scott has no business to write novels, especially good ones. It is not fair. He has Fame and Profit enough as a Poet"!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXVII "Scott - The Awakening of Romance

Ch.LXXVIII "Scott - 'The Wizard of the North'"

- What elements of Scott's subject matter and style seem distinctive to you?

→ READ

∞ Link: Lochinvar

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Percy Bysshe Shelley

📄 Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Sir Walter Scott from last week?

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley, wife of Mary Shelley (the author of *Frankenstein*). If you are also taking the Poetry course, you will read some

• COMPOSITION -

Compare/Contrast

Compare and contrast what you read of Shelley's *Defence to the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads*.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

of his poetry this week. However, today you will also read an excerpt from his Defence of Poetry, a philosophical essay on the nature and function of poets and poetry.

Do you recall any details about Shelley from the overview of the Romantic Period you read in Week 1?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Percy Bysshe Shelley Biography

2. Defence of Poetry

- What are the main points Shelley is making in this excerpt? What images and arguments stand out to you the most? What do you think he means by "poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world?"

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Percy Bysshe Shelley from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This article is fairly long. You may skim through the information about her early life with Percy Shelley, but be sure to read the excerpts of her travel writing and other prose towards the end of the article.

∞ Article Link: Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley Biography

- What aspects of Mary Shelley's character are evident in her writing? If you are reading Frankenstein this year, does knowing more about the author's life affect your reading of her work?

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

John Keats

Materials: English Literature for Boys and Girls

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXI "Keats - The Poet of Beauty"

- What are some connections between Keats and other writers you have studied this term? Which excerpts of his writing did you enjoy the most in today's reading?

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

WEEK 11 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

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Term 2	
WEEK 1	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13
WEEK 2	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14
WEEK 3	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15
WEEK 4	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16
WEEK 5	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17
WEEK 6	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18
WEEK 7	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19
WEEK 8	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20
WEEK 9	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21
WEEK 10	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22
WEEK 11	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23
WEEK 12	☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

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Term 3	
WEEK 1	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25
WEEK 2	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26
WEEK 3	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27
WEEK 4	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28
WEEK 5	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29
WEEK 6	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30
WEEK 7	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31
WEEK 8	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32
WEEK 9	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33
WEEK 10	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34
WEEK 11	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35
WEEK 12	30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36